

Cleaning, property and equipment safety

Operational standard for cleaning services | Original draft for review

Before accepting and entering

Check scope, access, time, equipment and any disclosed hazards. Accept only work you are competent and equipped to do. On arrival, reassess the space: exits, pets, children, damaged electrics, slippery floors, ventilation and unstable objects. Agree priorities and identify delicate surfaces. If the task is materially different or unsafe, pause and contact support rather than improvising or charging an unagreed extra.

Chemical controls

Use only approved, labelled products for their intended task. Read product instructions and the relevant assessment before use. A safety data sheet supports an assessment but is not itself a complete task assessment. Never mix products or transfer them to food/drink containers. Keep products secure from children and pets. Use the specified dilution, ventilation and protective equipment; do not invent stronger mixtures to work faster.

For spills or exposure, stop, keep others away and follow the product's emergency instructions. Obtain appropriate help; do not neutralise an unknown substance or attempt rescue in unsafe air. Report the product and incident. A competent person must approve product-specific controls and first-aid arrangements before release of this policy.

Cleaning method and hygiene

Use a task checklist and separate equipment for toilets and food/contact areas. Work in a sequence that avoids transferring dirt back to clean areas. Follow product contact times and surface instructions; do not claim disinfection from an ordinary wipe. Test compatibility only using an approved method and customer permission where relevant. Dispose of routine waste safely and wash/dry hands appropriately. Replace damaged gloves and use gloves suitable for the actual product and task.

Do not handle needles, unknown bodily fluids, suspected asbestos, pest contamination or extensive mould as ordinary cleaning. Isolate the area if safe and refer to an appropriately assessed specialist service. Do not conceal an incident or put hazardous material into ordinary household waste without an approved lawful route.

Equipment, movement and access

Check cords, plugs, guards and condition before using equipment. Remove defective items from use. Keep water away from electrical equipment and never bypass a safety feature. Avoid trailing leads and warn people about wet areas. Use suitable access equipment only within competence and assessment; do not stand on chairs, counters or unstable objects.

Plan movement of equipment and avoid hazardous lifting where practicable. Assess any unavoidable lift and reduce the risk with smaller loads, equipment or help. No single weight limit makes every lift safe. Do not move people or heavy customer furniture as an unassessed extra. Stop when the route, load or your capability makes the task unsafe.

Property, keys and completion evidence

Use documented key/code handover, minimise identifying labels and restrict access to the assigned job. Never duplicate keys without written authority. Report lost keys immediately and agree security action through support. Record pre-existing damage factually where relevant, avoid unnecessary household photographs and do not photograph private papers or people.

At completion, check the agreed work, remove waste and equipment, secure the property as instructed, return keys and record unfinished items honestly. Completion photos are evidence, not permission to publish. Let the customer raise a concern without pressure to approve or rate positively. Support should review disputes and any remedial visit.

Task risk assessment record

Booking/site: _____ Assessor/date: _____ Task and people affected: _____

Hazards: _____ Existing controls: _____ Additional action/owner: _____

Products and assessment references: _____ PPE/equipment: _____

Emergency/access arrangements: _____ Residual risk acceptable? _____

Stop conditions: _____ Briefing/sign-off: _____ Review trigger: _____

Sources and competence gate

HSE cleaning risks: <https://www.hse.gov.uk/cleaning/manage-risks.htm> HSE cleaning chemicals: <https://www.hse.gov.uk/cosHH/industry/cleaning.htm> HSE manual handling: <https://www.hse.gov.uk/msd/manual-handling/> These are baseline controls. A competent reviewer must tailor the assessment to the actual products, premises, equipment and tasks; a general policy cannot replace that assessment.